

DANFENG YUE

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EDUCATION

Toulouse School of Economics, France
Ph.D. in Economics (*Advisor: Ulrich Hege*) *2022–2027 (expected)*

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, United States
Visiting Ph.D. Student (*Finance Department, Host: Filippo Mezzanotti*) *Spring 2026*

Toulouse School of Economics, France
M.Sc. in Economics (with distinction) *2021–2022*

Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China
M.Sc. in Economics *2018–2021*
B.Sc. in Economics *2014–2018*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of Innovation, Corporate Finance, Industrial Organization

WORKING PAPERS

Adaptive Innovation by Recombining Knowledge (Job Market Paper)

Innovation investments are often specific, but the knowledge they create can be redeployed when economic conditions change. Using the 2014 *Alice Corp. v. CLS Bank International* decision, I show that innovators adapt to weakened patent protection by recombining affected knowledge with less-affected technological domains. This response is stronger when technologies can be more readily combined and when relevant complements already lie within firms' technological boundaries. Firms with greater access to these complementary technologies sustain more innovation and experience smaller declines in performance.

How Legal Remedies Drive Patent Litigation Explosions: Evidence from the *eBay* Ruling

This paper studies how changes in legal remedies affect patent litigation using the 2006 *eBay* ruling. A screening model and difference-in-differences evidence show that limiting the availability of injunctions increased litigation, particularly by patent assertion entities targeting high-sales firms, as the lower risk of losing sales encourages alleged infringers to resolve disputes through litigation.

WORK IN PROGRESS

From Ideas to Digital Products: How AI Expands the Innovation Frontier

This project studies how generative AI reshapes the entrepreneurial opportunity space and expands the frontier of realized innovation using natural language processing to decompose digital-product descriptions into the functions they perform.

LLMs as Knowledge Intermediaries: Do They (De)Centralize Innovation?

This project studies how LLMs reshape access to knowledge and change how innovators search for and acquire knowledge.

News-Based Measures: A Count Approach (with Christian Gouriéroux, Dogukan Guney, Nour Meddahi, and Wenxuan Wang)

This project develops a Poisson-based framework to characterize the data-generating process of unstructured text in French newspapers and construct economic indices.

PRESENTATIONS

Adaptive Innovation by Recombining Knowledge: TSE Finance Workshop (2025); Kellogg FINC Brown Bag (2026); TPRI Research Workshop (2026); Chicago Entrepreneurial Finance Workshop (2026); EEA-ESEM (2026); EARIE (2026); TSE PhD Student Workshop (2026; discussed by Doh-Shin Jeon).

How Legal Remedies Drive Patent Litigation Explosions: TSE Finance Workshop (2024); Entrepreneurship and Finance (ENTFIN) Conference, PhD Session and CASCAD Session (2025; discussed by Logan Emery).

SELECTED RESEARCH WORKSHOPS AND TRAINING

NBER Entrepreneurship Research Boot Camp 2025
organized by David T. Robinson and Jorge Guzman

SKEMA Knowledge, Technology, and Organization (KTO) Workshop 2025
organized by Ludovic Dibiaggio and Carla Rua-Gomez; group mentored by Samina Karim

Entrepreneurial Finance PhD Workshop 2025
taught by Michael Ewens, Gilles Chemla, and Jessica Jeffers

PhD Summer School on Finance and Product Markets 2024
taught by Laurent Fresard and Gordon Phillips

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Toulouse School of Economics
Intermediate Econometrics (Graduate) 2025
Program Evaluation (Graduate) 2024–2025
R Programming (Graduate) 2023–2024

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

EFA PhD Travel Grant 2025
Fondation Jean-Jacques Laffont PhD Scholarship 2022
Chinese National Scholarship 2019

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Software: Stata, LaTeX, Python, R
Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent)
Interests: Cooking, Chinese calligraphy